



Hacker's sentence quadrupled!

Alonzo Knowles has been sentenced 5 years in prison for hacking into celebrity emails, videos and TV scripts. <http://dgit.in/hckr5yrs>

Windows 10 "Home Hub"

Microsoft is seriously working on its Windows 10 to take on Google Home and Amazon's Alexa <http://dgit.in/Wndws10Hm>

Tomorrow's Tech

That aside, in terms of power generation and backup, and also the long term viability, the project is an ample proof of concept.

Tesla and SolarCity merger-what it means for the future of solar energy

The merger between Tesla and SolarCity has both critics and those who think it a great move for the future of solar energy.

As for Tesla, the hope probably is that the Ta'u project would act as an example that attracts potential customers. Also, on a commercial scale, Musk actually believes that the solar battery part of the business would one day cross the market for Teslas. There are, after all a number of places in the world where the appeal for reliable, independent power runs higher than that for electrical vehicles.



The future in the making?

Also, looking at their just concluded-project, the Ta'u island's location off the West Coast could be a great advantage for Tesla. It's a great location to harness the energy of the sun. Also, the possibility of expansion exists. Whether more locations can be supplied with energy by expanding the grid or not is something to be seen in the future.

Tesla completed the acquisition of SolarCity for \$2.6 billion. And though the CEO, Elon Musk said the need for such a merger is "blindingly obvious" the acquisition is still considered a risky move by many. The critics say that after all, the billions have been spent on buying a company that's not yet profitable. For every \$1 that the firm makes, it spends \$6.

Troubling as that aspect may be, the fact remains that Tesla is one of the few companies that have actually shown a pro-active interest in investing in green-energy technology. And as for SolarCity, it's certainly a fact that they were a comparatively small player. But on the other hand, they also possess a strong acumen on building solar technology products. What they lacked was the ability to scale up in such a way that the technology would impact a large population in the least amount of time.

But thanks to the acquisition by Tesla, that issue has now been solved, or so we can hope. In the final analysis, it's safe to say that the merger holds great promise for the future. In a fragile planet, everything depends on the pace with which such things happen.

Kamuthi Solar Power Project and the shape of things to come

The world's largest single location solar power project has been launched in Kamuthi in Ramanathapuram district in Tamil Nadu. The project, which has been launched by the Adani Green Energy (which is the energy wing of the Adani Group) has a capacity of 648 megawatts(MW). The investment for the project is a whopping ₹4,550 crore. The plant is spread over an area of 2,500 acres- that's enough land to organize 476 parallel football fields.

It contains 25 lakh individual solar panels which are cleaned every day by a robotic system. This robotic system itself is powered with solar energy-meaning the entire system is self-sustaining. The project would bring clean energy to 1.5 lakh homes.

The sheer size of the plant puts it at the center of discussions regarding the nation's ambitions to be certainly among the world's leading green energy generators.

To bring the mammoth project to life, about 8,500 people worked. This way, about 11 MW of installation was set up each day and the entire plant was completed in just 8 months. The power plant comes as part of the Tamil Nadu state government's plans to create 3

GW of solar power inline. Let us hope that the plan succeeds.

Before this, the title for the largest single-location solar plant belonged to California's Topaz Solar Farm (with a capacity of 550 MW).

India has made a decision to source 40 percent of the 100 GW power requirement using rooftop solar. If practical manifestations of the decision happen, it would mean that we are in for a sea change in the energy production arena in India. The reason



Fields of a solar dream

such a decision was made was because rooftop solar incurs practically no land acquisition cost and very little transmission cost – because the distance between the consumers and the solar panels is the shortest.

It's Tata Power which presently has the largest solar installed capacity in the nation (approx. 9 percent). This is followed by ACME (7 percent) and Sun-Edison (approx. 5.5 percent). The Adani group has amassed 5 percent.

While we could expect big-sized projects in the near future too, the writing on the wall is clear: For the common man, the biggest source of renewable energy would come from rooftop solar panels. So, the real revolution, from the everyday perspective, would not be brought by bigger plants but by the average Joe.

Interestingly, as a consequence, the one who benefits the most from this would also be the average Joe. Rooftop solar cell installations will eventually become self sustainable when the consumer is sufficiently educated regarding the process. On such a day, energy would be truly free. 